

Northwind Support Escalation Policy

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Owner: Customer Support Leadership

1. Severity definitions

- SEV-1 (Critical): Production outage or data loss affecting many customers.
- SEV-2 (High): Major feature unavailable with no practical workaround.
- SEV-3 (Medium): Degraded experience with a workaround available.
- SEV-4 (Low): Cosmetic issue or minor inconvenience.

2. Response time targets (business hours, CET)

- SEV-1: first response within 15 minutes; update every 30 minutes.
- SEV-2: first response within 1 hour; update every 2 hours.
- SEV-3: first response within 1 business day.
- SEV-4: first response within 3 business days.

3. Escalation path

- Tier 1 Support acknowledges the ticket and triages severity.
- Tier 2 Support owns SEV-2 and SEV-3 investigations.
- On-call Engineering owns SEV-1 until mitigation.
- Customer Success is notified for all SEV-1 accounts labeled Enterprise.

4. After-hours coverage

Only SEV-1 incidents page the on-call engineer outside business hours.
SEV-2 and below wait until the next business day unless an Enterprise contract explicitly includes 24x7 coverage.